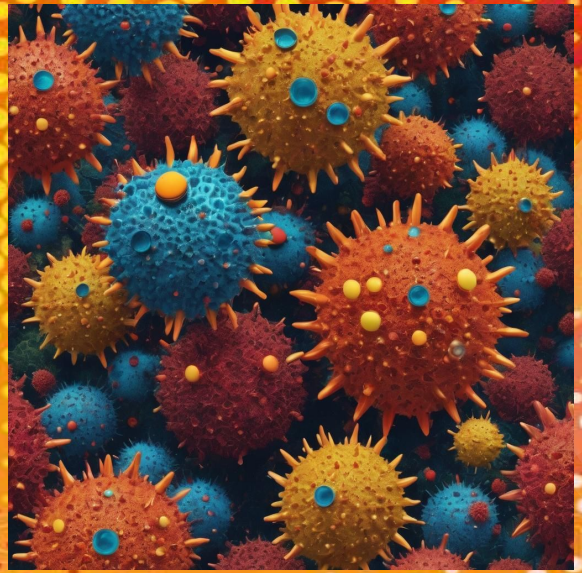
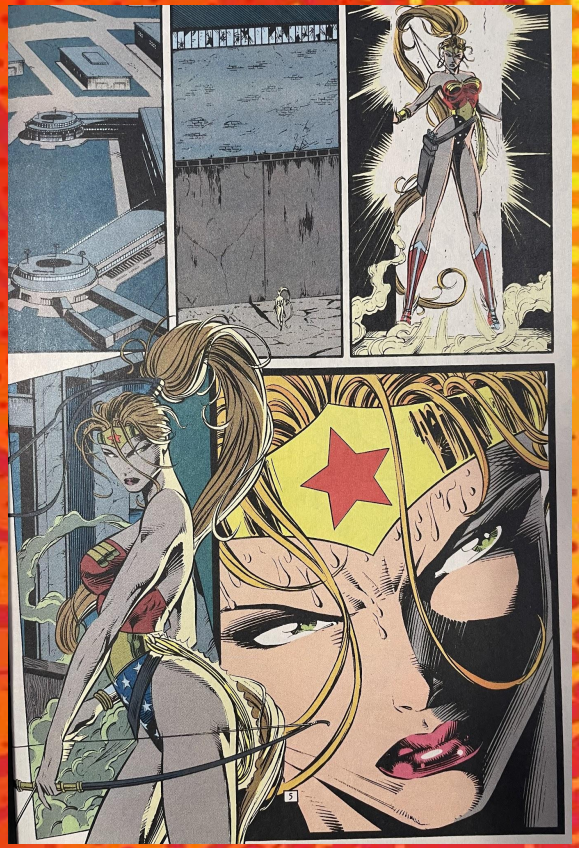
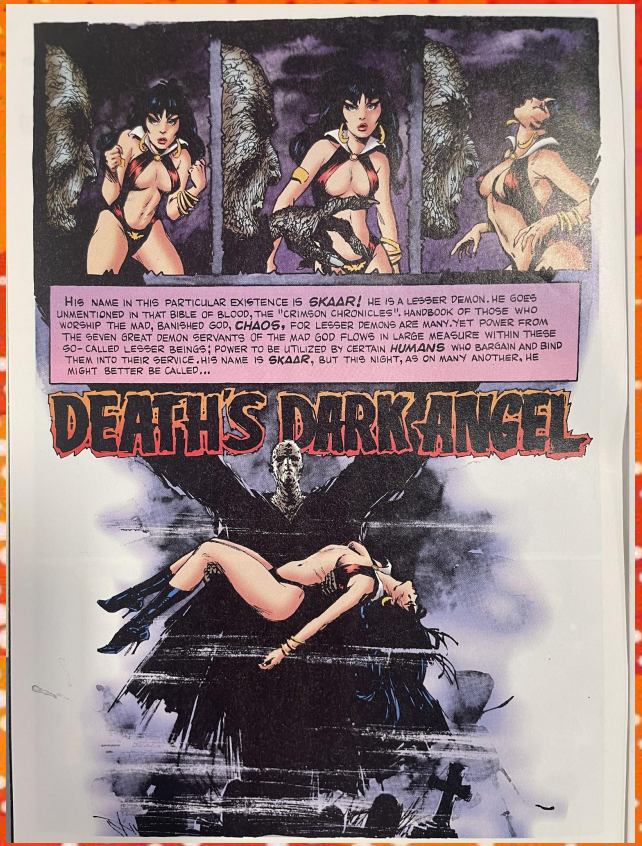


Design Process of MicroMedic

Art by Emma Brodsky
Character by Renuka, Kaitlin, Asmita, Aseel

Though the Comics Code no longer governs major comic book publishers, it continues to impact the portrayal of women in modern media. Under the Comic Code's guise of maintaining "decency" and "morality," female characters were often depicted in little clothing, striking provocative poses, and serving primarily as objects of desire or damsels in distress. These harmful tropes still exist in *current* media.





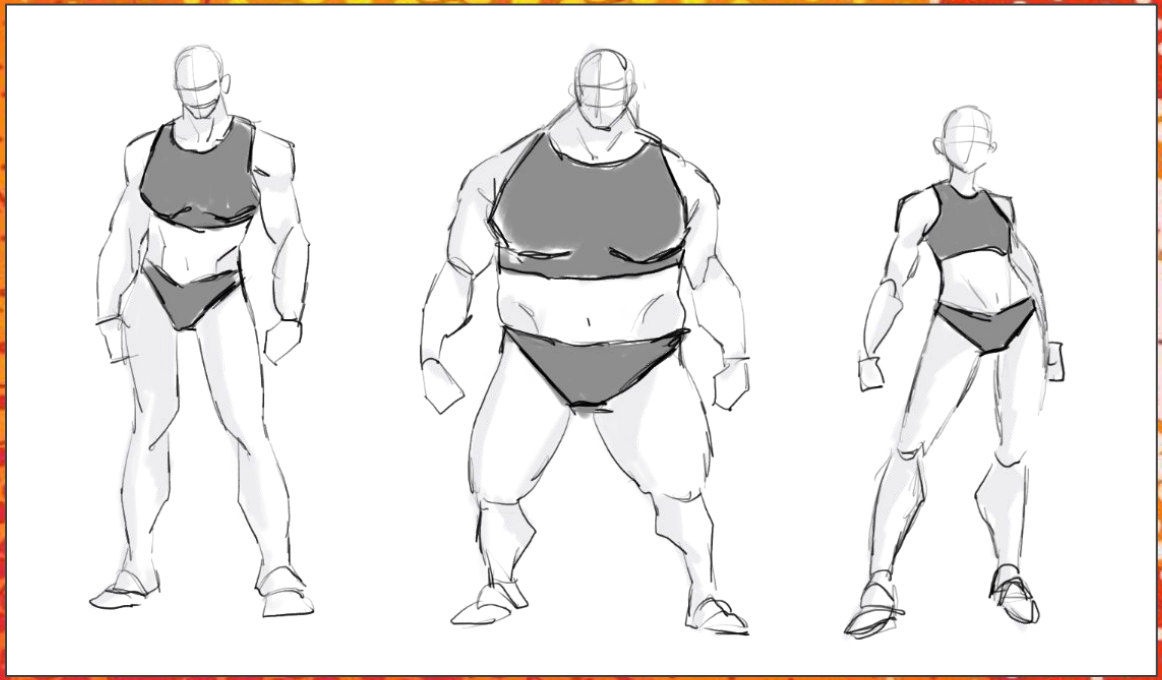
Collected by Nina, Anna, Jessica, Matthew

Modern comics, such as Bechdel's *Fun Home* and Ferris's *My Favorite Thing is Monsters* do an excellent job of creating multidimensional female characters with relatable stories surrounding their experience with girlhood. However, I have not yet seen emphasis placed on well-rounded character designs in superhero comics.

An effective character design goes beyond just the visual aesthetic, requiring the artist to thoughtfully incorporate the character's personality, backstory, and role within the narrative into the design itself. I felt that character design provided an effective medium to visually contrast problematic tropes prevalent in traditional superhero comics while capturing the intricacies of female characters developed in underground comics.

Throughout the process of creating this character, I felt that it was important to contrast traditional superhero tropes like overly sexualized costumes or exaggerated physical features by creating a character with a functional design.

Step 1: Stats



Step 2: Costume Design

Step 3: Character Design

I'm just a girl!

Just trust me!